C2 vocabulary list

Every key word from the ten stories, grouped by story. Cover one column and test yourself.

1. Cuplé de autor (An Original Verse)

la chirigota	comic carnival singing group from Cádiz (satire and jokes)
las preliminares	preliminary round (first phase of the contest)
la peña	club, society (where a group meets and rehearses)
el tipo	costume (of a carnival group)
el ensayo	rehearsal
el bombo	bass drum
la caja	snare drum
la grabación	recording
la letra	lyrics (of a song)
la rima	rhyme
el letrista	lyricist, lyric writer
el plagio	plagiarism
el veredicto	verdict
los pasodobles	pasodobles (serious or lyrical carnival songs)
el estribillo	chorus, refrain
el pito de carnaval	carnival kazoo
el cuplé	comic carnival verse with a punchline
la prueba	evidence, proof

2. La lonja del Mediomundo (The Drumhead from Mediomundo)

la lonja	drumhead (of cured hide)
el componedor	composing stick (typesetter’s tool)
la errata	misprint, typo
el conventillo	tenement house (rooms around a shared courtyard)
la vereda	pavement, sidewalk (Southern Cone)
tirar la toalla	to throw in the towel, to give up
la duela	stave (wooden strip of a drum or barrel)
el tachón	tack, stud (nail that fixes the drumhead)

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la gurisa	girl, kid (Uruguay; masc. el gurí)
el repique	repique (middle candombe drum that improvises)
el aro	hoop, rim
la fogata	street fire, bonfire
templar	to tune (a drum, by heating the head)
la mama vieja	mama vieja (elderly woman character in the comparsa)
el gramillero	gramillero (old herb-doctor character who dances with a bag of herbs)
el escobero	escobero (broom-twirling character who leads the drums)
la cuerda	the line of drums of a comparsa
el chico	chico (smallest, highest candombe drum that keeps the pulse)

3. Domplines para un campocorto (Dumplings for a Shortstop)

el buscador	(baseball) scout
la bandeja	tray
el ingenio	sugar mill
la báscula	scales (for weighing)
el campocorto	shortstop
rebajar	to lose weight, slim down
el caldero	heavy cooking pot (the Dominican cast-aluminium pot)
estar en olla	(Dominican) to be broke
la masa	dough
la servilleta	napkin
la ración	portion, helping
el tíguere	(Dominican) street-smart guy, hustler
la prueba	tryout
la cerca	fence
a escondidas	secretly, behind someone's back
el bono de firma	signing bonus
el ayudante de cocina	kitchen hand, kitchen assistant
ponerse para su número	(Dominican) to focus on what matters
amasar	to knead

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la víspera	the eve, the day before

4. La copla de Tocaña (The Verse from Tocaña)

la neblina	mist, low cloud
el cocal	coca field
la ladera	hillside, slope
el derrumbe	landslide, rockfall
el ensanche	widening (of a road)
la copla	sung four-line verse (in the saya, a topical stanza)
el caporal	lead dancer of the saya, who sets the step with bells (a figure based on the overseer)
la cuancha	notched bamboo scraper played in the saya
el aguayo	woven Andean cloth worn over the shoulders or used to carry things
el expediente técnico	technical file (the full design documents of a public works project)
la alcantarilla	culvert (pipe or channel carrying water under a road)
la cuneta	roadside ditch
la mazamorra	(Bolivia) mudflow, flow of mud and debris
el capataz	foreman
achicar (agua)	to bail out (water)
el talud	embankment, cut slope
el cafetal	coffee plantation
la chuspa	small woven bag for coca leaves (Andean)

5. Demasiado perfecta (Too Perfect)

la milpa	maize field (often intercropped with beans and squash)
la réplica	replica, copy
la ficha de inventario	inventory card, catalogue record
sepultar	to bury (sepultado: buried)
la ceniza volcánica	volcanic ash
el yacimiento	archaeological site, dig
el titular	headline
el saqueo	looting
la pieza	piece, artefact (museum object)

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la tefra	tephra (ash and rock fragments thrown out by a volcano)
la estratigrafía	stratigraphy (the sequence of layers in the ground)
la cerámica policromada	polychrome (painted, many-coloured) pottery
el comunicado	official statement, press release
el peritaje	expert examination, expert report
desportillado	chipped (on the edge or rim)
la denuncia	police report, formal complaint
la fe de erratas	correction notice, list of errata
la custodia	custody, safekeeping

6. El príncipe de bronce (The Bronze Prince)

el cronista	chronicler (official town historian)
el borrador	draft
la placa	plaque
develar	to unveil (a plaque or statue; Mexico)
la jarana	jarana (small eight-string guitar of son jarocho)
el palenque	maroon settlement (community of people who escaped slavery)
el cimarrón	maroon (person who escaped slavery and lived free)
de su cosecha	of one's own invention (lit. 'from one's own harvest')
el portal	porch, arcade in front of a house
el requinto	requinto (small lead guitar of son jarocho)
el bronce	bronze
el acta de cabildo	town council minutes
la leyenda	legend
echar la sal	to jinx, bring bad luck (Mexico)
la tarima	wooden dance platform (stamped on in son jarocho)
el zapateado	rhythmic stamping dance
la décima	décima (ten-line stanza of eight-syllable verse)
el versador	improvising verse singer
el fandango	fandango (son jarocho community celebration of music and dance)

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7. Ndaje (So They Say)

la intérprete jurada	sworn (court) interpreter
el juicio oral	oral trial (public trial with live testimony)
el incendio intencional	arson, deliberately started fire
el cañaveral	sugar-cane field
el lindero	property line, boundary between plots
el trapiche	small sugar-cane mill
la prueba testimonial	witness evidence, testimonial proof
el acta	official record, minutes (of a hearing or statement)
el fiscal	public prosecutor
el testigo / la testigo	witness
la audiencia	(court) hearing
prestar juramento	to take an oath, be sworn in
el acusado	defendant, the accused
el rastrojo	stubble (left in a field after harvest or fire)
la chispa	spark
el alegato	closing argument (in court)
absolver	to acquit (a defendant)
el falso testimonio	perjury, false testimony

8. La última palabra de Ma Petrona (Ma Petrona's Last Word)

la lengua criolla	creole language
el préstamo léxico	loanword, lexical borrowing
el/la informante	(language) informant, consultant in fieldwork
agonizar	to be dying, be in one's final days
el velorio	wake (vigil for the dead)
el lumbalú	lumbalú (Palenque funeral songs and dances)
el kuagro	kuagro (age group in Palenque social life)
el ataúd	coffin
la etnoeducación	ethno-education (Colombia's culturally specific schooling for ethnic communities)
desvelarse	to lie awake, lose sleep
la grabación de campo	field recording
la glosa	gloss (short explanation or translation of a word)

el sustrato	substrate (influence of an earlier language on another)
la raíz	root (of a word)
la loma	hill
el cimarrón / la cimarrona	maroon (escaped enslaved person in a free community)
encalado	whitewashed
el resumen	abstract (of an academic paper), summary

9. Lo que trajo el Crimea (What the Crimea Brought Back)

la cinta de casete	cassette tape
la UCI	ICU, intensive care unit
los trastos	junk, odds and ends
el portavasos	glass holder (here a Soviet metal tea-glass holder, podstakannik)
el guaje	kid, child (Asturias)
la nana	lullaby
el magnetófono	tape recorder
la grabación	recording
rebobinar	to rewind (a tape)
auscultar	to listen to the chest with a stethoscope, auscultate
la dacha	dacha, Russian country cottage
la transliteración	transliteration (writing one alphabet in another)
la repatriación	repatriation, return to one's own country
el expediente	file, official record
la casa de niños	children's home (Soviet homes for the evacuated Spanish children)
el huérfano	orphan
la bodega	hold (of a ship)
la sidrería	cider house (Asturian bar serving cider)
el escanciador	cider pourer (who pours cider from a height)
el chigre	traditional bar, tavern (Asturias)

10. Panalivio (Panalivio)

el cajón	cajón, Afro-Peruvian box drum (the player sits on it)

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el panalivio	panalivio, Afro-Peruvian lament song from the time of slavery
inmutarse	to show emotion, to bat an eyelid (usually negative: no se inmutó)
la marca	mark (here a sign used as a signature)
la hoja de encargo	engagement letter (client's contract with a lawyer)
la carta notarial	formal letter delivered through a notary (Peru), legal notice
la grabación de campo	field recording
el dominio público	public domain
la licencia	licence (permission to use a work)
los derechos conexos	related rights (of performers and producers)
el algodonal	cotton field
la quijada	donkey's jawbone used as a percussion instrument
la décima	décima, ten-line octosyllabic stanza, often improvised
la prórroga	extension (of a deadline)
el cuaderno de campo	field notebook
la conciliación	conciliation, out-of-court settlement procedure
saldar	to settle, pay off (a debt)
el acuerdo transaccional	settlement agreement
la regalía	royalty (payment for use of a work)

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